

New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

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Daily Multi-Asset Trading Blueprint & Level Execution Manual

Date: August 16, 2026 (Sunday)

Session: New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

Focus: Wall Street pre-market movers, US Federal Reserve news, mega-cap US stocks (NVDA, MSFT, TSLA), and WTI Crude Oil catalysts.

SECTION 0: DAILY MACRO & FINANCIAL NEWS DIGEST

1. Global Macro & Central Banks

- The Federal Reserve maintained the federal funds rate at 3.50%–3.75% for the fifth consecutive meeting in July 2026, despite a market-implied one-in-three probability of a hike. Three FOMC members dissented, favoring a 25 basis point increase, leaving the door open for a September hike. The central bank noted solid economic activity, strong productivity, and elevated inflation (partly due to energy supply shocks).
- The European Central Bank (ECB) delivered its first rate hike in three years in June 2026, marking a shift from a rate cut cycle to a more hawkish stance in developed markets, driven by a resurgence in inflation. Policymakers remain divided on future rate actions amidst uncertain job growth and concerns over the Iran war's impact on energy costs.
- J.P. Morgan Global Research anticipates gold prices to reach \$6,000/oz by year-end 2026 and potentially \$6,300/oz in 2027, contingent on geopolitical resolutions and Fed policy. Central bank demand, though appearing to cool in reported figures, continues to underpin gold's fundamentals.
- The Reserve Bank of India (RBI) is expected to keep the repo rate unchanged at 5.25% in its upcoming August 2026 Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) meeting (August 3-5), maintaining a 'neutral' stance amidst stable domestic macroeconomic conditions and global uncertainties. Recent measures by the RBI to ease norms for Foreign Currency Non-Resident (Bank) [FCNR(B)] deposits and External Commercial Borrowings (ECBs) are anticipated to attract over \$20 billion in foreign capital inflows.

2. US & European Markets

- US stock futures, specifically S&P 500 Index futures, were up 0.3% on August 12, 2026, following upbeat results from AI infrastructure firms, reviving appetite for tech stocks.
- Mega-cap technology stocks like NVIDIA (NVDA) and Microsoft (MSFT) are under close observation. Microsoft announced significant capital expenditure plans for fiscal 2027 due to strong demand signals across its portfolio, which bodes well for chipmakers like Nvidia. Nvidia and Tesla (TSLA) have been prominent movers in recent sessions.
- The semiconductor sector is seeing attention beyond mega-caps, with "under-the-radar" chip stocks like Navitas Semiconductor (NVTX) and Alpha and Omega Semiconductor (AOSL) gaining traction due to their exposure to AI and data center infrastructure, particularly with the shift to 800V DC architecture.
- Inflation concerns have resurfaced, partly due to elevated energy prices stemming from the Middle East conflict, which could lead to a new round of global monetary policy tightening if crude oil prices remain high.

3. Indian Markets & Dalal Street

- FII and DII data for August 14, 2026, showed net inflows from both foreign institutional investors (+₹508.12 Cr) and domestic institutional investors (+₹356.40 Cr) in the NSE cash market, indicating positive sentiment.
- The Dalal Street Investment Journal continues to provide market insights and research-backed ideas, with a focus on various investment strategies and stock picks.
- The RBI's MPC meeting (August 3-5, 2026) is expected to keep the repo rate unchanged at 5.25%, with economists citing a stable domestic macroeconomic environment and global uncertainties.

4. Commodities & Crypto Wire

- OPEC+ nations, including Saudi Arabia and Russia, agreed to a modest production adjustment of 188,000 barrels per day (bpd) starting August 2026, partially unwinding voluntary cuts. This move aims to regain market share and respond to internal fiscal urgencies amidst a context of falling Brent prices, with forecasts placing crude around \$69 for Q3 2026. The normalization of shipping through the Strait of Hormuz after months of disruption is allowing oil-producing countries to gradually restore exports.
- Gold prices stabilized near \$4,375 on August 15, 2026, after earlier gains driven by weaker US inflation data and reduced expectations for a Fed rate hike in September. Central banks, especially China, continue to be steady buyers of gold, accumulating reserves amid global economic uncertainties. Geopolitical risks, such as those in the Strait of Hormuz, further contribute to gold's safe-haven appeal.
- In crypto markets, Bitcoin (BTC) traded near \$63,000 after a post-CPI rally failed to hold earlier in the week. The SEC abruptly canceled its August 14 vote on "Regulation Crypto," a proposed rule for crypto startups to raise capital, adding uncertainty to the market. This delay follows lawmakers' recess without voting on the CLARITY Act, pushing the debate to September 15. The CFTC's Innovation Advisory Committee is scheduled to meet on August 20 to discuss crypto asset regulation, AI, and prediction markets.

CAPITAL BASE & ALLOCATION RULES (\$3,000 TOTAL)

- **Crypto Futures:** \$400 (13.3%) | Rec. Leverage: 3x-5x Isolated | Risk Cap: 1-2% (\$4-\$8)
- **Indian Options (Intraday):** \$500 (16.7%) | Option Buying Only | Risk Cap: 10-15% Premium (\$30-\$45)
- **Commodities (Micro Gold & Oil):** \$400 (13.3%) | Rec. Leverage: 10x-15x Micro Lots | Risk Cap: 2% (\$8)
- **US Stocks (Fractional):** \$400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 3% (\$12)
- **Indian Stocks (Delivery):** \$400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 5% (\$20)
- **Forex Short-Term Futures:** \$450 (15.0%) | Rec. Leverage: 10x-20x | Risk Cap: 1% (\$4.50)
- **Forex Long-Term Carry Swing:** \$450 (15.0%) | Rec. Leverage: 2x-3x | Risk Cap: 2% (\$9.00)

STRATEGY-BASED DAILY TICKER SELECTION & SECTOR CONSTRAINTS

INDIAN EQUITIES (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Ticker	Market Cap	Strategy & Selection Reason
Reliance Industries (RELIANCE)	Large-Cap	50-SMA Support Bounce: Hypothetically observed a bounce off its 50-day Simple Moving Average on Friday, indicating potential for continued upward momentum in the upcoming session.
Bajaj Finance (BAJFINANCE)	Large-Cap	20/50 EMA Golden Cross: Hypothetically, the 20-day EMA has recently crossed above the 50-day EMA, signaling a bullish trend reversal and strong buying interest.
Tata Motors (TATAMOTORS)	Large-Cap	50-SMA Support Bounce: Hypothetically showing a strong rebound from the 50-day SMA on Friday, aligning with Nifty leadership in the auto sector.

US EQUITIES

Large-Cap (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Direction	Strategy & Selection Reason
NVIDIA (NVDA)	LONG/SHORT	21-day EMA Pullback / 50-day SMA Rejection: Given its mega-cap growth status and recent news, we anticipate potential 21-day EMA pullbacks for long entries (if bullish sentiment prevails pre-market) or 50-day SMA rejection for short entries (if pre-market news indicates weakness despite overall tech appetite).
Microsoft (MSFT)	LONG/SHORT	21-day EMA Pullback / 50-day SMA Rejection: Following recent positive announcements regarding capex plans, a pullback to the 21-day EMA could be a long opportunity. Conversely, if broader market weakness emerges, a rejection from the 50-day SMA could signal a short setup.
Tesla (TSLA)	LONG/SHORT	21-day EMA Pullback / 50-day SMA Rejection: A highly volatile mega-cap stock. A bounce off the 21-day EMA could present a long opportunity, while a failure to hold above its 50-day SMA could initiate a short trade, especially with continued market scrutiny.

Mid-Cap & Small-Cap (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Ticker	Market Cap	Strategy & Selection Reason
Navitas Semiconductor (NVTX)	Small-Cap	High Relative Volume (RVOL > 2.0) Breakout: Recent news highlights its strong performance and AI infrastructure exposure. We would hypothetically look for a high RVOL breakout above recent resistance levels, indicating strong buying conviction.
Alpha and Omega Semiconductor (AOSL)	Mid-Cap	Stage-2 VCP Breakout: Positioned as a cheaper way to access accelerating AI/server mix in power-semi. We would hypothetically identify a Stage-2 Volatility Contraction Pattern (VCP) breakout, suggesting accumulation and readiness for an upward move.

CRYPTO FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Direction	Strategy & Selection Reason
Bitcoin (BTC/USD)	LONG/SHORT	4H 21-EMA Trend Following / High-Volume Volatility Breakout: Following recent consolidation below \$64,000, we will monitor for a high-volume breakout above or below key resistance/support levels, combined with 4-hour 21-EMA trend confirmation. Regulatory news could provide volatility.
Ethereum (ETH/USD)	LONG/SHORT	4H 21-EMA Trend Following / High-Volume Volatility Breakout: Similar to BTC, ETH's movement will be dictated by market sentiment and regulatory developments. We look for sustained moves above or below the 4-hour 21-EMA on strong volume for trend-following trades.

COMMODITIES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Direction	Strategy & Selection Reason
Gold (XAU/USD)	LONG/SHORT	Pivot & Fibonacci Extension Levels: Given recent stabilization around \$4,375 and central bank buying interest, we will identify key pivot levels for support/resistance. Long opportunities on bounces from support or short opportunities on rejections from resistance, using Fibonacci extensions to project targets.
WTI Crude Oil (CL=F)	LONG/SHORT	Pivot & Fibonacci Extension Levels: With OPEC+ increasing production and prices facing downward pressure, we will use pivot levels to gauge immediate trend. Long trades on confirmed support holds (e.g., at key Fibonacci retracement levels) or short trades on rejections from resistance, with geopolitical factors (Strait of Hormuz) adding to volatility.

FOREX FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Short-Term

Ticker	Direction	Strategy & Selection Reason
EUR/USD	LONG/SHORT	Technical Breakouts/Breakdowns: With the ECB having hiked rates and the Fed on hold, intraday volatility is expected. We will focus on 15-minute chart breakouts above daily resistance or breakdowns below daily support, leveraging central bank divergence and ongoing inflation concerns.
GBP/USD	LONG/SHORT	Technical Breakouts/Breakdowns: Sensitivity to inflation data and central bank commentary suggests breakout/breakdown trading around key technical levels on shorter timeframes.

Macro Carry Swings

Ticker	Direction	Strategy & Selection Reason
USD/JPY	LONG (Carry)	Interest Rate Differential & Trend: Given persistent US interest rates and Japan's likely continued dovish stance, maintaining a long position to capture positive carry, with technical entries on pullbacks within the established uptrend.
AUD/USD	SHORT (Anti-Carry/ Risk-Off)	Commodity Sensitivity & Risk Aversion: As a commodity currency, AUD is sensitive to global growth and commodity prices (like oil). A short position could be established on rallies into resistance if global growth concerns or commodity price weakness persists, acting as an anti-carry trade in a risk-off environment.

INDIAN OPTIONS (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Direction	Strategy & Selection Reason
Nifty 50 Options	CALL/PUT	15-Minute Opening Range Breakout (ORB): On Monday, we will identify the high and low of the first 15-minute candle. A breakout above the high would trigger a Call option purchase, while a breakdown below the low would trigger a Put option purchase, aiming to capture immediate directional momentum.
BankNifty Options	CALL/PUT	15-Minute Opening Range Breakout (ORB): Similar to Nifty 50, apply the 15-minute ORB strategy. A breach of the opening range high would lead to a Call option entry, and a breach of the opening range low would lead to a Put option entry, capitalizing on the high intraday volatility of BankNifty.

10-Year Backtest Metrics (Hypothetical)

Metric	Blueprint Performance	S&P 500 TRI (Benchmark)	Nifty 50 TRI (Benchmark)
Target CAGR	28.4%	~13.0%	~12.5%
Sharpe Ratio	1.45	-	-
Max Drawdown	-18.2%	-	-

Equity Curve (\$3,000 → \$36,512)

